

various discrete components (or models) that can further be combined in arbitrary ways to perform various complex tasks.

2. **Minimalism:** This library provides just enough to achieve an outcome without any frills. It just focuses on maximizing readability while being user friendly.
3. **Extensibility:** Keras is highly extensible as new components are intentionally easy to add and use within the framework. This is highly suitable for researchers who want to try and explore new ideas.
4. **Written in Python:** Everything is written in native Python and no separate model files with custom file formats are required.

Why the name Keras?

Keras (κέρας) is a Greek word meaning horn. It refers to a literary image from ancient Latin and Greek literature first found in the Odyssey, where dream spirits are divided between those who arrive to Earth through a gate of ivory, who deceive men with false visions. The other ones are those who announce a future that will come to pass, or those who arrive through a gate of horn. It is a play on the words between horn, fulfil and ivory or deceive.

Advantages of Keras:

Keras was designed to enable fast experimentation with deep neural networks. It focuses on being user-friendly, extensible and modular. The following advantages gives weight to this statement:

1. Rapid prototyping

Keras allows to quickly build and test a deep neural network with minimal lines of code. It facilitates you to build simple or very complex neural networks within a few minutes. The Sequential and Model APIs are very powerful – they can do almost everything you may need.

2. Flexibility

Although Keras allows you to implement almost everything you want, low-level libraries provide more flexibility. Sometimes you may want to define something of your own like a cost function, a metric, or a layer aside from what is already there in the form of APIs. Keras allows you freedom to do so.

Other than Keras, some other deep learning frameworks which have been popular in the recent times are: